What Others Say

"Neerja was a very sensitive, deeply affectionate and an extremely decent person who believed in sharing with her people all her joys but not the jolts. She had well defined principles and there was little room for compromise in that area."

Harish Bhanot, Neerja's Father

Dr Kishore Murthy, a passenger on the flight said, "She was at the entrance of the aircraft when the terrorists boarded. She could have escaped like the pilots did, but she didn't do it. That shows her guts and inner strength. She was truly a great leader."

Eliza Lewis, another classmate spoke about how Neerja was always brave. "If she had not done anything wrong, she would never cower when the teachers got angry. She would speak her mind, tell them the truth," she said about Neerja.

Vrinda Kirloskar, Neerja's classmate from Bombay Scottish, told The Indian Express, "She was a loyal friend. Even if we had a disagreement, she would always be the first one to reach out."

Rukshana Eisa, Neerja's roommate during the Pan Am training said, "This was not a job meant for dumb blondes. We worked hard."

Think and Answer

1. According to Neerja's father, Neerja had well defined principles and there was little room for compromise in that area. Do you have any principles where you don't want to compromise?
2. Virinda told the Indian Express that Neerja was a loyal friend. Are you always loyal to your friend?
3. Neerja would speak her mind, tell them the truth, according to one of her classmates Eliza. Do you always have the courage to stand for truth?

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